



CALICUT UNIVERSITY – FOUR-YEAR UNDERGRADUATE PROGRAMME (CU-FYUGP)

BA ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE HONOURS

MAJOR

Programme	BA ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE HONOURS				
Course Code	ENG6CJ304 /ENG8MN304				
Course Title	NARRATIVE CONSTRUCTS IN NON-FICTION				
Type of Course	MAJOR				
Semester	VI				
Academic Level	300 – 399				
Course Details	Credit	Lecture per week	Tutorial per week	Practical per week	Total Hours
	4	4	-	-	60
Pre-requisites	Basic Knowledge of different aspects of Fiction and Non- Fiction				
Course Summary	This course aims to provide learners with a comprehensive understanding of the different genres of non-fiction while encouraging critical engagement with topics of contemporary relevance.				

Course Outcomes (CO):

CO	CO Statement	Cognitive Level*	Knowledge Category#	Evaluation Tools used
CO1	Identify the key features of non-fiction as a literary genre	U	C	Exam/Quiz/Assignment
CO2	Understand personal narratives that shape our understanding of identity and place.	U	C	Assignment / Exam
CO3	Analyse how historical and victim narratives provide insights into human behaviour and societal development	An	C	Seminar /Presentation / Exam
CO4	Examine how essays and journalism represent and critique societal norms and politics.	E	C	Exam / Assignments
CO5	Explore how documentary writing and social commentary reflect and influence societal perceptions, cultural identities, and social change.	E	C	Exam/Assignments
CO6	Demonstrate necessary skills and proficiency in composing non-fiction.	C	P	Assignment/ Seminar
* - Remember (R), Understand (U), Apply (Ap), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C) # - Factual Knowledge(F) Conceptual Knowledge (C) Procedural Knowledge (P) Metacognitive Knowledge (M)				

Detailed Syllabus:

Module	Unit	Content	Hrs	Marks
I	Biography/Autobiography/Memoir		12	18
	1	Introducing subgenres of Non-Fiction: Biography, Autobiography and Memoir	3	
	2	Into the Wild (Chapter 1)- <i>The Alaska Interior</i> - Jon Krakuer	3	
	3	<i>The Long Walk to Freedom</i> (Chapter 23)- Nelson Mandela	3	
	4	An extract from <i>When Breath Becomes Air</i> - Paul Kalanidhi -pp.238-246	3	
		Suggested Activity: 1. Debates and discussions on the different forms of self-narratives 2. Prepare an assignment on the different points of view in self-narratives.		

II	Non-fiction and Journalism		12	17
	5	Introducing subgenres like features, sports journalism and travel writing	3	
	6	Messi emulates Maradona in fairytale ending to a story like no other-Sid Lowe (Guardian, Sport blog, 18 Dec 2022)	3	
	7	The Fourth Dimension - Jan Morris	3	
	8	Desperate Peoples: The Vanishing World of India's tribes (Frontline, August 2010)- P. Sainath	3	
	Suggested Activities: 1. Select a diverse set of news articles from various reputable sources (e.g., The New York Times, BBC, Al Jazeera). Ensure the topics are current and relevant. 2. Invite a guest speaker (e.g., a local journalist, professor, or community leader) or use role-playing where one learner acts as the interviewee with a prepared backstory. 3. Present a brief scenario based on a current event (e.g., a local community event, a political announcement, a scientific discovery).			

III	Contemporary Non-Fiction		12	17
	9	Introducing terms: History/Self Help/Victim Narrative	3	
	10	Modern Time -An Extract from <i>Sapiens: A Brief History of Humankind</i> by Yuval Noah Harari - pp 394-398	3	
	11	The Man Who Didn't Look Right (Chapter 4)- <i>Atomic Habits</i> - James Clear	3	
	12	The Last Girl (Part II, Chapter 9)- Nadia Murad & Jenna Krajeski	3	
	13	Suggested Activities: 1. Provide examples of short excerpts from contemporary memoirs (e.g., works by Tara Westover, Trevor Noah, or Michelle Obama) and ask learners to choose a meaningful personal experience from their own lives. 2. Select a list of contemporary non-fiction essays that tackle current issues (e.g., climate change, social justice, technology). Examples could be sourced from publications like The Atlantic, and The New Yorker etc. ask the learners to choose an essay from the list to read and analyze. 3. Provide examples of contemporary literary journalism profiles (e.g., pieces by Gay Talese, Susan Orlean, or Joan Didion). Ask the learners to choose a person to profile in a similar pattern (e.g., a local artist, community leader, or someone they know with a compelling story)		

IV	Audio-visual Dimensions of Non-Fiction		12	18
	14	Introducing podcasts, video essays, TED talks and adaptations of non-fiction works into feature films and documentaries	3	
	15	Podcast: Murdered from Crime Junkies https://open.spotify.com/episode/6eWAYJsY2VfSMd0cl9r3t5?si=eq1jR8rWRAqRAUGH71P9pw	2	
	16	Why Your Body Language Shapes Who You Are(Ted Talk) -Amy Cuddy	2	
	17	I Feel I Have Blood on my Hands from <i>The American Prometheus (Oppenheimer (2023): Chapter 24)</i>	3	
	18	Head Transplants and the Non-Existence of the Soul-Joseph Geller	2	
		Suggested Activities: 1. Provide examples of high-quality non-fiction podcasts (e.g., episodes from "This American Life," "Serial," or "Radiolab") Instruct learners to prepare similar podcasts. 2. Show clips from acclaimed short documentaries (e.g., "The White Helmets," "Period. End of Sentence.") and discuss key elements like narrative structure, visuals, and interviews. 3. Provide examples of multimedia journalism projects (e.g., The New York Times' "Snow Fall," National Geographic's interactive features) and discuss how text, images, audio, and video are combined to tell a story.	2	
V	Open Ended Module		12	

Note: The course is divided into five modules, with four having total 18 fixed units and one open-ended module with a variable number of units. There are total 48 transaction hours for the fixed modules and 12 hours for the open-ended one. Internal assessments (30 marks) are split between the open-ended module (10 marks) and the fixed modules (20 marks). The final examination, however, covers only the 18 units from the fixed modules.

Suggested Reading:

1. *Giving up the Ghost: A Memoir* - Hillary Mantel
2. *The Wings of Fire* - Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam
3. *Becoming* - Michelle Obama
4. *The Great Railway Bazar* by Paul Theroux - Bruce Chatwin
5. 'The Street Use of Solitude' A News Feature from *The Reader's Digest* (February 12, 2024)
6. "India Takes the World Cup in Grand Style" Ram Mahesh (The Hindu, 02/04/2011)
7. 'Seven murders, one confession and missing evidence: The 'Ripper' story' by Nidhish M K, published in *The News Minute*.
8. *Freedom at Midnight* by Larry Collins and Dominique Lapierre
9. *Things We Didn't Talk About When I Was a Girl* by Jeannie Vanasco "How to find creativity and purpose in the Face of Adversity" by Suleika Jaouad - TED Talks Daily 06/03/24
10. The Muzafir stories - Podcast on travel
11. Is There a Sane Way to Use the Internet? (Ezra Klein podcast)
12. *I am Not Your Negro* - 2016 film based on James Baldwin unfinished work *Remember this House*

Mapping of COs with PSOs and POs:

	P S O 1	P S O 2	P S O 3	P S O 4	P S O 5	P S O 6	P O 1	P O 2	P O 3	P O 4	P O 5	P O 6	P O 7
C O 1	-	-	2	2	-	-	2	-	-	-	-	-	-
C O 2	1	-	3	-	2	2	3	2	-	-	-	1	-
C O 3	-	-	-	2	2	2	2	2	-	-	2	2	-
C O 4	-	-	2	-	2	2	-	2	-	-	2	2	-
C O 5	-	-	2	2	2	2	2	2	-	-	-	1	-
C O 6	2	-	1	-	2	2	1	-	-	-	2	2	-

Correlation Levels:

Level	Correlation
-	Nil
1	Slightly / Low
2	Moderate / Medium
3	Substantial / High

Assessment Rubrics:

1. Quiz/ Discussion/ Seminar (10%)
2. Internal Exam (10%)
3. Assignment (10%)
4. End Semester Exam (70%)

Mapping of Cos to Assessment Rubrics:

	Quiz/ Discussion/ Seminar (10%)	Internal Exam (10%)	Assignment (10%)	End Semester Exam (70%)
CO 1	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO 2	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO 3	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO 4	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO 5	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO6	✓	✓	✓	✓